Spencer Perry

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Research Fields

Applied Microeconomics, Public, Health, Labor, Environmental

Academic Positions

Assistant Professor of Economics and Public Policy *August 2025 - Present*
Institute of Social and Economic Research, University of Alaska Anchorage

Postdoctoral Scholar *July 2024 - July 2025*
Center for Economic and Social Research, University of Southern California

Education

Arizona State University, Ph.D. in Economics *2018-2024*
Davidson College, B.A. in Economics, *cum laude* *2011-2015*

Publications and Accepted Papers

Balancing College and Work Activities: The Gig Economy Meets Online Education [Draft]
with Esteban Aucejo and Basit Zafar | Accepted at the **Journal of Labor Economics**

Optimal Second-best Menu Design: Evidence from Residential Electricity Plans [Draft]
with Maria Garcia-Osipenko, Nicolai Kuminoff, and Nicholas Vreugdenhil | Conditionally Accepted at the **Journal of the European Economic Association**

Working Papers

Dynamic Complementarity in Public Insurance Provision: Evidence from the Medicaid Expansion [Draft]

Work in Progress

The Value of Insuring Against Dementia-Related Financial Risk
with Nicholas Papageorge and Kevin Thom

The Fog of Innovation: Belief Heterogeneity and Labor Reallocation at the Dawn of AI
with Jacob French

Substance Use, Genetic Risk, and the Long-Term Incidence of Alzheimer's Disease and Related Dementias: Evidence from Historic Excise Taxes on Alcohol and Tobacco

Cognitive Decline and Health Insurance Decisions and Outcomes
with Jonathan Ketcham and Nicolai Kuminoff

Non-Peer Reviewed Publications

"Moving Out to Move Up: Who Leaves and Where Do They Go?" *with Raven Molloy and Christopher L. Smith* In "Locked in Place," ed. Stanford Center on Poverty and Inequality, Winter 2019, Pathways Magazine.

Grants

NBER's Coordinating Center on the Economics of Alzheimer's Disease and Related Dementias: Early Career Research on Economics of Alzheimer's/Dementia, 2026-2028. $50,000. For "Substance Use, Genetic Risk, and the Long-Term Incidence of Alzheimer's Disease and Related Dementias: Evidence from Historic Excise Taxes on Alcohol and Tobacco"

Salt River Project, 2023-2024. $50,042. For "Predicting Residential Price Plan Enrollment and Energy Use" *with Nicolai Kuminoff and Nicholas Vreugdenhil*

Teaching Experience

Instructor - University of Alaska Anchorage

Methods in Public Policy Evaluation, Spring 2026
Introduction to Economics for Managers, Fall 2025, Fall 2026

Instructor - Arizona State University

Public Economics, Fall 2022 & Spring 2023

Teaching Assistant - Arizona State University

Labor Economics, Econometrics, Honors Intermediate Microeconomics

Presentations & Workshops

2026 NBER's Coordinating Center on the Economics of ADRD Fall Meeting, Arizona State University PhD Reunion Conference, University of Pennsylvania's Population Aging Research Center, University of Michigan's Center to Accelerate Population Research in Alzheimer's, NBER's Coordinating Center on the Economics of ADRD Annual Meeting (Poster Presentation)

2024 University of Alaska Anchorage, University of Texas San Antonio, Federal Trade Commission, Office of Management and Budget

2023 NBER Economics of Education Program Meeting, NBER Behavioral Public Economics Bootcamp, Western Economics Association Graduate Student Workshop, Eastern Economics Association Conference, American Society of Health Economists Annual Conference

2022 APPAM 2021 Fall Research Conference

Professional Experience

Federal Reserve Board of Governors *2015 – 2018*
Senior Research Assistant

Referee Experience

The Economic Journal, American Journal of Health Economics, Economic Modeling